

Plant up to unplug

Modern living is increasingly dominated by the screen-based technologies of our phones, tablets, laptops, and televisions. While social media can provide a fantastic platform for sharing knowledge and inspiration, not least of the natural world, it is easy to become a slave to the algorithms.

Take a houseplant break

We all know the feeling of needing to disconnect and spend some time away from the screen. Caring for living plants provides that escape and washes away the pressures of the constantly connected world by replacing it with plants that don't make constant demands of us.

Looking at screens for long periods of time can also impact our physical health, leading to strained, dry eyes, blurred vision, and headaches. Our posture while engaging with technology can place strain on the spine, too, leading to aches and pains in the back and neck. So having a “houseplant break” to care for plants by watering,

feeding, and generally appreciating them will not only clear our heads but also give physical relief, refreshing both our minds and bodies.

Blue buzz, green relief

The presence of nature can help our brains work better, with research showing that we associate the color green with happiness, comfort, hope, and peace. This knowledge can help us combat the unseen effects of the technology all around us. The blue light emitted by computers, smartphones, and TVs, for example, can contribute to sleep issues by suppressing the sleep-promoting hormone melatonin. You can counteract this with foliage, as the green of your houseplants can instill feelings of tranquility, safety, and calmness—the ideal conditions for a good night's sleep—and cleanse the air as you snooze.

